

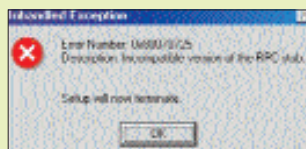
Dumb DLLs!

Q Recently, when installing a software, I got an error message: "Error number:0x0070725

Description: Incompatible Version of the RPC stub
Setup will now terminate"

I cannot install this software and it's important to me. I have a Pentium III with 192 MB RAM running Win 98.

Arijit, Via e-mail



<http://snipurl.com/digitqa7>.
Select Start > Shutdown > Restart in MSDOS mode and click 'OK'. At the command prompt, enter the following commands:

```
CD c:\windows\system
rename oleaut32.dll oleaut32.old
exit
```

Windows will restart. Ignore the error message that follows. Now run the downloaded file DCOM95.EXE or DCOM98.EXE according to your version of Windows. This will install the correct version of the file oleaut32.dll. Restart Windows.

Your software should install now. However, if your computer fails to function properly after you do this, you can restore the original file by following these steps. Select Start > Shutdown > Restart in MSDOS mode and click 'OK'. At the command prompt, enter the following commands:

```
CD c:\windows\system
rename oleaut32.old oleaut32.dll
exit
```

Windows will restart.

A This error is caused by an incompatible version of a DLL file that was installed on your system, such as Oleaut32.dll, Olepro32.dll, Asyncfilt.dll, or Stdole2.tlb. There are three possible solutions.

If Microsoft Office 2000 or a component is installed, go to <http://snipurl.com/digitqa5> and install Office 2000 Service Release 1. If not, download and install the MCRRepair Tool from <http://snipurl.com/mcrepairpatch>. When prompted to overwrite newer files, click 'Yes' for each file.

The above solution applies to all versions of Windows, but the next solution applies for Windows 95/98 only: in Windows 95/98, this error is caused by a bad version of oleaut32.dll. Remove the old file and reinstall it. Be warned that this requires modifications to the System folder, and if not done correctly, can cause serious problems.

Download but do *not* run <http://snipurl.com/digitqa6> for Windows 98. For Windows 95, download—but do *not* run

QUESTION
OF THE
MONTH

Windows XP does not allow a system file to be replaced while it is in use and hence, you will not be able to replace or delete it in the Windows XP environment. But there is a way around this. You can rename the file you wish to delete and replace. Then, copy the replacement system file to the location of the original file. With this, there is no need to boot into DOS.

You may do this using Windows Explorer. When you boot the next time, the new file will be loaded as the system file and if necessary, you may delete the file you renamed earlier. But it is always wiser to keep that file as a backup.



was no longer there. Now it shows up as free space. Even recovery software can't read this partition anymore. How can I recover my data? This machine was running Windows 98. How can I save other machines from such a problem?

Piyush, via e-mail

A From what you've described, it seems that an electric surge has destroyed the data on your D: drive. The only way to prevent such a thing from happening again is by installing an online UPS for all your computers.

To recover data from crashed drives, there are some software solutions such as RFAT Studio, EasyRecovery Pro, etc. that you could try.

Encryption Issues

Q My system is running Windows XP Professional (SP2). Recently, I reinstalled the OS and now, I cannot access documents and files. They show up in green, and the 'Properties' tab shows that these are encrypted. How can I access these files?

Babu, via e-mail

A It seems that your C: drive uses the NTFS file system and that the files were encrypted with a password. Hence, these files will be accessible only to the user of the previous installation of Windows XP. You'll be able to decrypt these files using software such as Advanced EFS Data Recovery, which you can download from <http://snipurl.com/digitqa3>.

Surging Loss!

Q I have seven machines in my office connected on a LAN. Recently, when I restarted one of the machines due to a flickering screen, the D: partition

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we will answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!

Corrupt Registry Keys

Q I'm having a problem installing programs such as MSW LOGO and Q BASIC. When I get about installing them, a message box appears, stating: "C:\PROGR~1\Symantec\S32EVNT1.DLL. An Installable Virtual Device Driver failed DLL Installation. Close/Ignore". What do I do?

Jayesh S Pandya, via e-mail

A Open the registry editor. Locate the key HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\VirtualDeviceDrivers\VDD. Delete this key. Then, add a value with VDD as the Value Name, and REG_MULTI_SZ as the Data Type. When the multi-string editor appears, leave the entry blank. If this doesn't work, or if you are unable to create the VDD key, it may be necessary to delete the entire VirtualDeviceDrivers key. ■